

SCHOOL OF LIFE FOUNDATION

The Architecture of Grace



BOOK THREE · THE INTERIOR

Autism-Adapted Edition

VISUAL ANCHOR CHARTS · TEACHER SUPPLEMENT

Grades 6-8 · Middle School

*Designed for autistic learners with lower support needs
(formerly described as Level 1 / mild-to-moderate)*

Twenty-eight printable anchor charts · One per page
*Preserving the curriculum's theoretical foundation, with autism-specific scaffolding built
into Tier 1 design*

Pilot Version · 2026–2027 · Confidential — For District Review Only
Original curriculum: James Anthony Ramsden, Founder

Before You Begin

What Book Three asks of an autism-aware classroom

This supplement is not a new curriculum. It is the same twenty-eight anchor charts from *Architecture of Grace · Book Three · The Interior*, rebuilt by a multidisciplinary team — autism specialist, school psychologist, school social worker, special education teacher, speech-language pathologist, and occupational therapist — with autistic students with lower support needs held as the design audience from the first line.

What did NOT change

- Every defined construct — *Mask, Mirror, Internal Critic, Compassionate Witness, Digital Backpack, Choice-Agency Map, Forgiveness, Reconciliation, Grace, Mercy* — appears exactly as the curriculum defines it.
- The theoretical foundation — Brown, Neff, Enright & Fitzgibbons, Worthington, Frankl, Siegel — is preserved.
- The pedagogy — predictable opening rituals, Compassionate Witness standard, Disclosure Protocol, counselor co-facilitation on flagged lessons — is unchanged.

What is new in this Book

- **The Mask vs. Mirror chart carries an added panel.** For autistic adolescents, masking is not a universal teen experience — it is documented survival behavior linked to autistic burnout, depression, and elevated suicide risk. The chart now names this directly and states explicitly that *this room is a place where unmasking is allowed*.
- **The Pause and the Forgiveness vs. Reconciliation charts carry a pattern-tracking guardrail.** The "charitable interpretation" framing, taught without this guardrail, can train autistic students to repeatedly override accurate threat detection.
- **The Crisis Resources page carries an autism-specific addendum.** Autistic adolescents are at significantly elevated suicide risk. The team agreed this must be named on the chart — not buried in a footnote.
- **Specialist Notes** appear on every chart, with what to watch for, what to honor, and what to never force.

A NOTE ON GRADES 6–8

Middle school is the highest-stakes period of the curriculum for autistic students. Masking peaks here. Friendships shift from interest-based to status-based, often shutting out autistic peers. Demands for inferential social reading exceed many students' current capacity. Sensory load is high. *If you are teaching this curriculum to an autistic 6–8 student, assume they are doing more work than you can see to be in your room. Design accordingly.*

Mask vs. Mirror

Who am I when I'm performing — and who am I when I'm not?

THE MASK · What I Show	THE MIRROR · What Is True
Perform. What I emphasize for the audience in front of me.	Real opinions. What I actually think when no one is watching.
Edit. What I leave out, soften, or rewrite for safety.	Actual struggles. What I'm carrying that the Mask never shows.
Hide. What I keep behind the curtain so it can't be used.	Real values. What I would protect even if no one applauded.

"The gap between these two is where the cost lives."

A NOTE FOR AUTISTIC STUDENTS IN THIS ROOM

For many autistic people, the Mask is not optional social performance — it is survival behavior built from years of being told who to be. Sustained masking is linked to **autistic burnout**, depression, and exhaustion. Unmasking is not "less effort" — for many autistic people, it is the harder thing to do.

This room is a place where unmasking is allowed. You do not have to perform here. *Listening looks different in different bodies. Stimming is welcome. Quiet is welcome.*

SPECIALIST NOTE · FOR THE TEACHER

This is the single most important chart in Book Three for autistic students. The original framing treats masking as a universal teen experience — for autistic students it is something specific, documented, and costly. The added panel must be on the chart, and must be read aloud during the lesson. *Watch for students who go very still during the Mirror introduction, or who deflect the discussion entirely. Note privately. Follow Disclosure Protocol if anything else surfaces.* Post before class on Day 1. Keep all year.

ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE

This is a free preview.

Autism-Adapted · Book 3 · Lower Support

The complete set is part of the Architecture of Grace district curriculum. Educators can license the full library; families can find materials in the family store.

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